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Graduate Recruitment Team

ICG

Procession House, 55 Ludgate Hill

London EC4M 7JW

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the 2027 Graduate Programme (Investment) in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. ICG's final close of Europe Fund IX at €12 billion in September 2026, which it describes as the largest dedicated structured capital fund raised globally, shows the kind of flexible capital I want to learn to structure.

My preparation for investing has come from taking deals apart. As co-founder and Treasurer of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, the university's first agri-finance society, I grew membership to 126 and led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC, breaking down why the buyer wanted the asset, how the deal was structured and how the stake was valued. My strongest academic results reflect the same interest: 90% in first-year Finance and 78%, the second-highest mark, in a third-year group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets.

Private equity appeals to me because the investor owns the outcome: the thesis has to be delivered after the deal closes, not just argued before it. I have seen that side at a small scale. As Head Mixologist at Le Set, a new 200-cover Glasgow venue, I created its house cocktails, set the specifications for its classics and trained around 15 bar staff to deliver them from launch. Before that, at KONG, I analysed sales patterns and refined our upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%. Both roles taught me that value is created in execution: in standards, training and small commercial decisions that compound.

ICG's structured capital strategy stands out to me because it sits between debt and equity, so every investment has to be designed around the needs of a company and its owners; Europe Fund IX closed in September 2026 at €12 billion, 50% larger than its predecessor, with 77% of existing investors committing again. Analysing how Olam Agri's stake sale to SALIC was structured taught me that the shape of a deal can matter as much as its price, and I would like to learn that discipline at a firm that has made it a speciality.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan